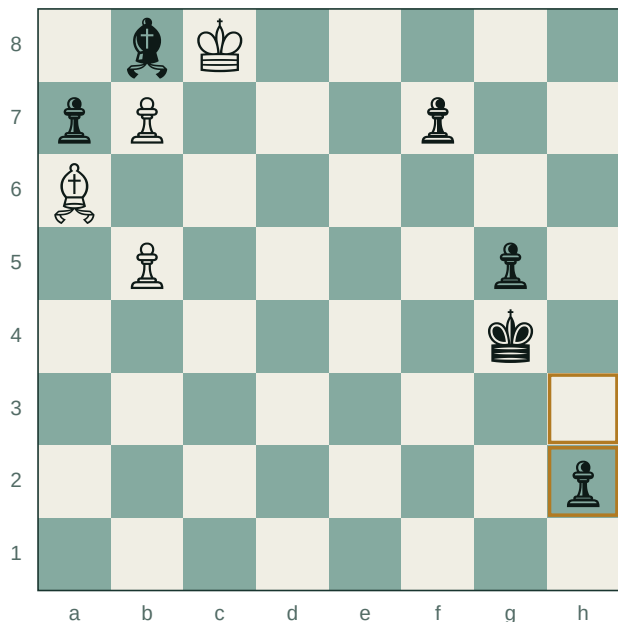


Bishop-ending decisions: White, move 44

Bishop-ending decisions

White to move



Previous move: 43...h2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

44. Kxb8 h1=Q 45. Kxa7 Qd1 46. b8=Q

44.Kxb8 The king captures the bishop on b8. Recorded reply: **44...h1=Q**.

45.Kxa7 The king captures the pawn on a7. Recorded reply: **45...Qd1**.

46.b8=Q The pawn moves from b7 to b8. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -2 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Same-colored and opposite-colored bishop endings have different tendencies, but neither label replaces calculation of the actual pawn races.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A bishop ending depends on diagonal access, pawn color, king activity, and promotion squares. Tactics can arise when a bishop must perform two defensive jobs.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the bishop's line to each target and identify pawns that can break its coverage or force it to move.

The defending king is on g4. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b8. Check for tactical protection.